CAMBRIDGE
International Education

# Cambridge O Level

**BIOLOGY** **5090/41**

Paper 4 Alternative to Practical **May/June 2024**

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 40

**Published**

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

Cambridge International will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge International is publishing the mark schemes for the May/June 2024 series for most Cambridge IGCSE, Cambridge International A and AS Level and Cambridge Pre-U components, and some Cambridge O Level components.



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**[Turn over**

**PUBLISHED**

## Generic Marking Principles

These general marking principles must be applied by all examiners when marking candidate answers. They should be applied alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptions for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme will also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptors for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptors for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always **whole marks** (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded **positively**:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptors.

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| GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:<br><br>Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however; the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen). |
| GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:<br><br>Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptors in mind. |

**Science-Specific Marking Principles**

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|---|---|
| 1 | Examiners should consider the context and scientific use of any keywords when awarding marks. Although keywords may be present, marks should not be awarded if the keywords are used incorrectly. |
| 2 | The examiner should not choose between contradictory statements given in the same question part, and credit should not be awarded for any correct statement that is contradicted within the same question part. Wrong science that is irrelevant to the question should be ignored. |
| 3 | Although spellings do not have to be correct, spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. ethane / ethene, glucagon / glycogen, refraction / reflection). |
| 4 | The error carried forward (ecf) principle should be applied, where appropriate. If an incorrect answer is subsequently used in a scientifically correct way, the candidate should be awarded these subsequent marking points. Further guidance will be included in the mark scheme where necessary and any exceptions to this general principle will be noted. |
| 5 | <u>'List rule' guidance</u><br><br>For questions that require ***n*** responses (e.g. State **two** reasons …):<br><br>• The response should be read as continuous prose, even when numbered answer spaces are provided.<br>• Any response marked *ignore* in the mark scheme should not count towards ***n***.<br>• Incorrect responses should not be awarded credit but will still count towards ***n***.<br>• Read the entire response to check for any responses that contradict those that would otherwise be credited. Credit should **not** be awarded for any responses that are contradicted within the rest of the response. Where two responses contradict one another, this should be treated as a single incorrect response.<br>• Non-contradictory responses after the first ***n*** responses may be ignored even if they include incorrect science. |

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|---|---|
| 6 | Calculation specific guidance<br><br>Correct answers to calculations should be given full credit even if there is no working or incorrect working, **unless** the question states 'show your working'.<br><br>For questions in which the number of significant figures required is not stated, credit should be awarded for correct answers when rounded by the examiner to the number of significant figures given in the mark scheme. This may not apply to measured values.<br><br>For answers given in standard form (e.g. $a \times 10^n$) in which the convention of restricting the value of the coefficient ($a$) to a value between 1 and 10 is not followed, credit may still be awarded if the answer can be converted to the answer given in the mark scheme.<br><br>Unless a separate mark is given for a unit, a missing or incorrect unit will normally mean that the final calculation mark is not awarded. Exceptions to this general principle will be noted in the mark scheme. |
| 7 | Guidance for chemical equations<br><br>Multiples / fractions of coefficients used in chemical equations are acceptable unless stated otherwise in the mark scheme.<br><br>State symbols given in an equation should be ignored unless asked for in the question or stated otherwise in the mark scheme. |

Mark schemes will use these abbreviations:

**;** separates marking points
**/** alternatives
**()** contents of brackets are not required but should be implied
**R** reject
**A** accept (for answers correctly cued by the question, or guidance for examiners)
**Ig** ignore (for incorrect but irrelevant responses)
**AW** alternative wording (where responses vary more than usual)
**AVP** alternative valid point (where a greater than usual variety of responses is expected)
**ORA** or reverse argument
**underline** actual word underlined must be used by candidate
**+** statements on both sides of the **+** are needed for that mark

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| Question | Answer | Marks | Guidance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1(a)(i) | absorbed by the chemical ; | 1 | |
| 1(a)(ii) | as $O_2$ is used up by the animals / taken in + not replaced by carbon dioxide / it has been absorbed ;<br>(overall) volume / pressure in apparatus decreases ; | 2 | **A** if oxygen only mentioned<br>**R** references to amount |
| 1(b)(i) | 1.3 ;<br>5.6 ; | 2 | 2 correct answers = 2<br>1.1 and 5.4 = 1 |
| 1(b)(ii) | time on x-axis + both axes fully labelled ;<br>linear scales + value(s) at origin + good use of grid ;<br><br>5 plots correct ;<br><br>points joined with ruled lines + no extrapolation ; | 4 | Minimum – position of drop / cm and t / min<br>**R** T<br>Graph must cover at least half the space in each direction<br><br>**A** dots alone<br><br>**R** anything over half a square, line not through centre of the point |
| 1(b)(iii) | correct value from graph ;<br>graph working shown ;<br>correct units ; | 3 | 4.05<br>**A** correct reading from candidate's graph<br>Minimum single line drawn to indicate value for 25 mins<br>cm |
| 1(c)(i) | 4.3 ; | 1 | 5.6 – 1.3 = 4.3<br>**ecf** for incorrect answer in ci |
| 1(c)(ii) | working shown;<br>correct rate to 2 decimal places ; | 2 | 4.3 / 40<br>0.1075<br>**A** 0.108, 0.11, 0.1<br><br>ecf if not using 4.3<br>no ecf for incorrect expression |

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| Question | Answer | Marks | Guidance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1(d)(i) | identify anomalies / outliers **AW** ;<br>to make the results more reliable ; | **2** | **Ig** to stop / avoid making errors<br><br>**R** references to accuracy, precise and valid e.g. in accurate and reliable |
| 1(d)(ii) | (use same apparatus with) no animals ; | **1** | **Accept** replace animals with something inert |

| Question | Answer | Marks | Guidance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2(a)(i) | Correct order: *Araneus, Lithobius, Musca, Macromia* = 3 marks | **3** | |
| 2(a)(ii) | 1 number of segments/body parts **AW** ;<br><br>2 relative shapes/number of segments **AW** ;<br><br>3 *Lithobius* has antennae, Araneus does not ;<br><br>4 Legs on one segment/legs on many segments<br><br>5 More joints in the *Araneus* leg | **1** | |
| 2(b)(i) | Correct orientation + clear and clean lines drawn with a sharp pencil **+** no shading + approximately horizontal;<br><br>minimum body size 75 mm;<br><br>Tail thinner at the end closed off and delimited ;<br><br>prolegs / tube feet along the level part of body ;<br><br>tail aligned with body (A* mark detail) ; | **5** | |

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| Question | Answer | Marks | Guidance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2(b)(ii) | correct measurement **+** units ;<br>**A** 49–51 mm<br>**A** 5.0 cm or 5 cm | **1** | |
| 2(b)(iii) | Correct answer for measurement in **(b)(ii)** / 16 ;<br><br>49 mm = 3.0625 3.1<br>50 mm = 3.125 3.1<br>51 mm = 3.1875 3.2 | **1** | |

| Question | Answer | Marks | Guidance |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3(a)(i) | 88 ;<br>324 ; | **2** | |
| 3(a)(ii) | Increases / higher with exercise + decreases/lower after exercise ;<br>doesn't return to resting value after 3 minutes ; | **2** | |
| 3(b)(i) | 1 Method mark – e.g. finger on pulse and count beats for 15 seconds using of stop-watch / timer ;<br>2 correct multiplication to get rate in 60 seconds ;<br>3 (resting) pulse rate determined before exercise ;<br>4 same type / intensity of exercise;<br>5 same age / gender<br>6 same time for exercise ;<br>7 pulse rate taken after exercise at fixed intervals (1 minute max if interval given);<br>8 repeat investigation at least three times and calculate a mean (to check for reliable results) ; | **6** | |
| 3(b)(ii) | heart / pulse rate **or** time for pulse rate to return to resting ; | **1** | |

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